

Key exam vocabulary

General Training reading and writing

The key vocabulary is a list of words that occur in IELTS Target 5.0 and that you should learn to improve your performance in the Reading and Writing Modules of the IELTS exam. It is a list of words and phrases that frequently occur in the type of texts that you will read in the IELTS General Training exam and which you will need to write effectively, especially in the second writing task. These words will also help you to understand certain topics in the Listening Module better.

Some very common words and phrases are not included in the list because you will already know what they mean and how to use them. Vocabulary that you will need for the speaking exam is not included in the list as this vocabulary is more personal to you. Look back at the first module of each unit to check particular words and phrases that you need to improve your speaking.

Spend some time checking all the words and phrases in the list and check anything you are not sure about in a good dictionary.

A

achieve (v)
achievement (n)
acquire (v)
activity (n)
advantage (n)
(can / cannot) afford
(v phrase)
ambition (n)
ambitious (adj)
annual (adj)
apology (n)
applicant (n)
appliance (n)
application (n)
apply (for) (v)
appointment (n)
appreciate (v)
approach (v/n)
arrange (v)
assess (v)
atmosphere (n)
attempt (n/v)
attitude (n)
authority (n)
avoid (v)

B

ban (v/n)
behave (v)
behaviour (n)
belong to (v phrase)

C

calculate (v)
cancel (v)
capacity (n)
career (n)
case (n)
cause (v/n)
century (n)
challenge (n)
climate (n)
communication (with)
(n/n phrase)
complain (v)
complaint (n)
concentrate (v)
congested (adj)
congestion (n)
consist of (v phrase)
construct (v)
construction (n)
(be in) contact (with)
(n/v phrase)
control (v/n)
cope with (v phrase)
courage (n)
course (n)
create (v)
creation (n)
crime (n)
criminal (n)
currently (adv)

D

(cause) damage
(n/v phrase)
danger (n)
dangerous (adj)
deal with (v phrase)
decide (v)
(make a) decision
(n/v phrase)
degree (n)
delay (n)
(be) delayed (v phrase)
difficulty (n)
demonstrate (v)
demonstration (n)
design (n)
develop (v)
development (n)
device (n)
diagram (n)
disagreement (n)
discover (v)
discovery (n)
discuss (v)
discussion (n)
dispose of (v phrase)

E

economic (adj)
(the) economy (of a
country) (n/n phrase)

educate (v)
education (n)
efficient (adj)
energy (n)
environment (n)
equipment (n)
exhibition (n)
exist (v)
existence (n)
expansion (n)
expand (v)
experience (n)
exploration (n)
explore (v)
export (v/n)
extend (v)
extinct (adj)
extreme (adj)
event (n)

F

facilities (n)
fail (v)
failure (n)
fear (n)
finally (adv)
finance (n)
financial (adj)
financial support
(n phrase)
firstly (adv)
freedom (n)

frequently (adv)
function (v/n)

G

gain (n)
generation (n)
graduate (n)

H

habit (n)
historic (adj)
history (n)
however (conj)
(have an) idea (v phrase)

I

ignore (v)
illegal (adj)
(have an / use your)
 imagination
 (n/v phrase)
image (n)
imagine (v)
immediately (adv)
import (v/n)
impressive (adj)
improve (v)
improvement (n)
incident (n)
inconvenience (n)
inconvenient (adj)
increase (v/n)
industrial (adj)
industry (n)
influence (v/n)
(have an) influence (on)
 (n/v phrase)
information (n)
intelligent (adj)
invest (in) (v)
invitation (n)
involve (v)
issue (n)

J

judge (v)
(make a) judgement
 (n/v phrase)

L

limit (v/n)
luxury / luxuries (n)

M

magnificent (adj)
matter (n)
measure (v)
memorize (v)
memory (n)
modern (adj)

N

natural environment
 (n phrase)
necessity / necessities (n)

O

obstacle (n)
occasionally (adv)
offence (n)
offend (v)
operate (v)
operation (n)
(be) opposed to
 (v phrase)
overcome (v)
own (v)

P

penalty (n)
permanent (adj)
permanently (adv)
personal qualities
 (n phrase)
plenty (of) (n/adj phrase)
polluted (adj)
pollution (n)
position (n)
possibility (n)
poverty (n)
power (n)
powerful (adj)
predict (v)
(make a) prediction
 (n/v phrase)
prefer (v)
pressure (n)
prevent (v)
prevention (n)
process (n/v)
produce (v)
product (n)
profession (n)
professional (adj)
profit (n)
progress (n)

project (n)
property (n)
provide (v)
punish (v)
punishment (n)
purchase (v/n)

R

raise (money) (v phrase)
rarely (adv)
reach (v)
react (to) (v)
reaction (n)
recall (v)
receive (v)
record (v)
reduce (v)
reflect (v)
reflection (n)
release (v)
(be) released (from)
 (v phrase)
relevant (adj)
rely (on) (v)
remain (v)
(have a) reputation
 (n/v phrase)
respect (v/n)
respond (to) (v)
(as a) result (of)
 (n/prep phrase)
result (in) (v)
revise (v)
rise (v/n)
risk (n)
rural (adj)

S

safety (n)
separate (adj)
(be) separated (from)
 (v phrase)
situation (n)
social issue (n phrase)
solution (n)
solve (v)
source (n)
speed (n)
strength (n)
structure (n)
succeed (v)
success (n)
successful (adj)

suffer (from) (v)
support (n)
survive (v)
symptom (n)

T

technique (n)
technological (adj)
technology (n)
temporarily (adv)
temporary (adj)
therefore (adv)
(have a) thought
 (n/v phrase)
tourism (n)
tradition (n)
traffic (n)
transfer (v/n)
transport (n/v)
treat (v)
treatment (n)
trust (v/n)
truth (n)

U

unlikely (adj)

V

value (n)
victim (n)
violence (n)
violent (adj)
volume (n)

W

waste (v/n)
wealth (n)
whole (adj)
(be) worth (v phrase)

Work-related vocabulary

Check these words and phrases to help you with the second part of the Reading Module (training survival). Some are included in the general vocabulary and some are not.

A

accountant (n)
achieve (v)
achievement (n)
ambition (n)
ambitious (adj)
application (n)
apply (for) (v)
apprentice (n)
assistant (n)

B

boss (n)

C

career (n)
challenge (n)
challenging (adj)
client (n)
colleague (n)
communicate (with) (v)
communication (n)
company (n)
customer (n)

D

deal with (v phrase)

E

efficient (adj)
employ (v)
employee (n)
employer (n)
employment (n)
entrepreneur (n)
executive (n)

F

factory (n)
firm (n)

I

(the) ... industry (n phrase)
interview (v/n)

M

manage (v)
manager (n)
management (n)

O

office (n)
out of work (adj phrase)

P

past experience
(n phrase)
pay (n)
pension (n)
position (n)
previous experience
(n phrase)
produce (v)
product (n)
production (n)
profession (n)
professional (adj)
profit (n)

Q

qualified (adj)

R

repetitive (adj)
retire (v)
retirement (n)
rewarding (adj)

S

salary (n)
set up (a business)
(v phrase)

staff (n)

stress (n)
stressful (adj)
succeed (v)
success (n)
successful (adj)

T

training (n)

U

unemployed (adj)
unemployment (n)

V

(business) venture
(n/n phrase)

W

well paid (adj)
work (as / for / in / with) +
noun (v phrase)
workplace (n)